

# Pierluigi Baroncelli

## Lead Product Designer

Design Systems · Fintech · EdTech · AI-Native Product Design

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### PROFILE

Lead Product Designer with 15+ years shaping fintech, edtech and web products end-to-end. Most recently Head of Product Design at Times Higher Education, where I built the organisation's first design system and led the flagship platform redesign for 10,000+ university customers worldwide. Earlier highlights include the GlintPay app redesign, Tide's desktop onboarding, and NatWest CurrencyPay's activation flow. I now pair 15 years of craft with AI-native workflows — prototyping and shipping production interfaces with Claude and shadcn/ui.

### KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- ◆ **Built THE's first design system** — cut design-to-dev delivery time ~40%, ensured WCAG compliance, adopted across every platform.
- ◆ **Led THE's flagship platform redesign** — phased rollout improving usability and engagement for 10,000+ university customers.
- ◆ **Directed the DataPoints redesign** — unlocked a new revenue stream for THE by improving data clarity and partner adoption.
- ◆ **Redesigned the GlintPay app** (iOS/Android) end-to-end — sharper clarity and engagement across the full customer journey.

### CORE SKILLS

Strategy & UX

Discovery

Information architecture

Research

Prototyping

Design Systems

Design tokens

Scalability

WCAG compliance

Dev handoff

Leadership

Stakeholder alignment

Agile delivery

Team mentoring

Specialisms

Fintech

EdTech

Publishing platforms

AI / LLM design

Tools

Figma

Claude

shadcn/ui

Miro

Jira

Confluence

Hotjar

Maze

### EXPERIENCE

**Senior Product Designer** 1st Formations · Contract **SAAS** Jan — Apr 2026

- Updated and extended UI components to align with brand standards.
- Adapted shadcn/ui as the foundation for the design system, improving consistency and developer handoff.
- Explored AI-assisted design workflows using Claude to accelerate delivery.

**Head of Product Design** Times Higher Education **EDTECH** Nov 2022 — May 2025

- Promoted from Principal Designer to found and lead THE's design function — the org's first design leadership hire.
- Took the design system and DataPoints from pilot to organisation-wide adoption, owning the roadmap end-to-end with engineering and product leadership.
- Directed the flagship platform's phased global rollout across every university customer.
- Grew and mentored the design team, embedding research and analytics into executive-level strategy.

**Principal Product Designer** Times Higher Education **EDTECH** Feb 2021 — Oct 2022

- Took the design system and DataPoints from early groundwork to shipped v1s, shaping platform updates and new feature rollouts.
- Introduced cross-team design reviews — first formal collaboration process between design, product and engineering.

**Senior Product Designer** Times Higher Education · Contract **EDTECH** Aug 2020 — Jan 2021

- Delivered core product improvements and early features that improved usability.
- Laid the groundwork for the THE Design System, creating reusable patterns that later scaled.

**Senior Product Designer** NatWest CurrencyPay · Contract **FINTECH** 2020

- Designed the KYC onboarding and activation process — improved activation and compliance.
- Collaborated with product and engineering to deliver customer-focused features.

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| <b>Senior Product Designer</b> Tide · Contract FINTECH                                                                                                                                                            | 2020        |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>– Supported design of the desktop banking app in the context of open banking.</li> <li>– Designed the in-app notification system.</li> </ul>                               |             |
| <b>Senior Product Designer</b> GlintPay · Contract FINTECH                                                                                                                                                        | 2018 – 2019 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>– Redesigned iOS and Android apps end-to-end for a fintech product built on open banking.</li> <li>– Created a more cohesive, usable cross-platform experience.</li> </ul> |             |
| <b>Product Design Lead</b> Hive · Contract E-COMMERCE                                                                                                                                                             | 2016 – 2018 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>– Redesigned Hive's e-commerce website — improved product discovery, checkout and payment flows.</li> </ul>                                                                |             |
| <b>Senior Product Designer</b> Schibsted Media Group · Contract MARKETPLACE                                                                                                                                       | 2016        |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>– White-label marketplace platform — focused on search and filtering for product discovery.</li> </ul>                                                                     |             |
| <b>Senior Product Designer</b> OVO Energy · Contract ENERGY                                                                                                                                                       | 2016        |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>– Helped redesign iOS and Android apps, delivering wireframes and mockups.</li> </ul>                                                                                      |             |
| <b>Senior Product Designer</b> HSBC · Contract BANKING                                                                                                                                                            | 2015        |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>– Responsive UI design for the HSBC banking website via HeathWallace.</li> </ul>                                                                                           |             |

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## EARLIER ROLES

Kabbee — Senior Product Designer (2015) · Dennis Publishing — Lead Mobile Designer (2014) · Fanatix — Mobile Designer (2013) · Moneywise — Product Designer (2013) · MailOnline — Product Designer (2011–2012)